

## **Statement of Informed Consent**

Please read this consent agreement carefully before deciding whether to participate in this experiment.

This experiment is part of a Virginia Tech scientific research project (IRB 26-418). Your decision to participate in this experiment is voluntary. There is no way for us to identify you. The only information we will have, in addition to your responses, is the time at which you completed the survey. The results of the research may be presented at scientific meetings or published in scientific journals. Selecting the checkbox and clicking on the 'Continue' button on the bottom of this page indicates that you are at least 18 years of age and agree to participate voluntarily.

Purpose of the research: To examine how people gather information about unknown risky assets.

What you will do in this research: Text and images will be presented on the computer and you will be asked to make choices.

Time required: Participation will take between 20 and 40 minutes to complete.

Risks: The effects of participating should be comparable to those you would experience from viewing a computer monitor for the task duration and using a mouse or keyboard.

Benefits: This study provides no benefits to you individually. The study provides important information about how people make decisions. Others may benefit in the future from the results of this study.

Compensation: You will receive \$5.00 for completing the task, and possibly an additional bonus payment of up to \$10.00. Bonus payments will depend on you the results of your decisions.

Participation and withdrawal: Your participation in this study is completely voluntary and you may refuse to participate or you may choose to withdraw

at any time without penalty or loss of benefits to which you are otherwise entitled.

How to contact the researcher: If you have questions or concerns about your participation or payment, or want to request a summary of research findings, please contact Ross Spoon: [rspoon@vt.edu](mailto:rspoon@vt.edu)

Whom to contact about your rights in this research: For questions, concerns, suggestions, or complaints that have not been or cannot be addressed by the researcher, or to report research-related harm, please contact the Virginia Tech HRPP Office at 540-231-3732 ([irb@vt.edu](mailto:irb@vt.edu)) Please print or save a copy of this form for your records.

**Agreement:**

The nature and purpose of this research have been sufficiently explained and I agree to participate in this study. I understand that I am free to withdraw at any time without incurring any penalty.